Office for National Statistics

Labour Force Survey

User Guide

VOLUME 4a – Updates to the LFS Education Derived Variables 2022

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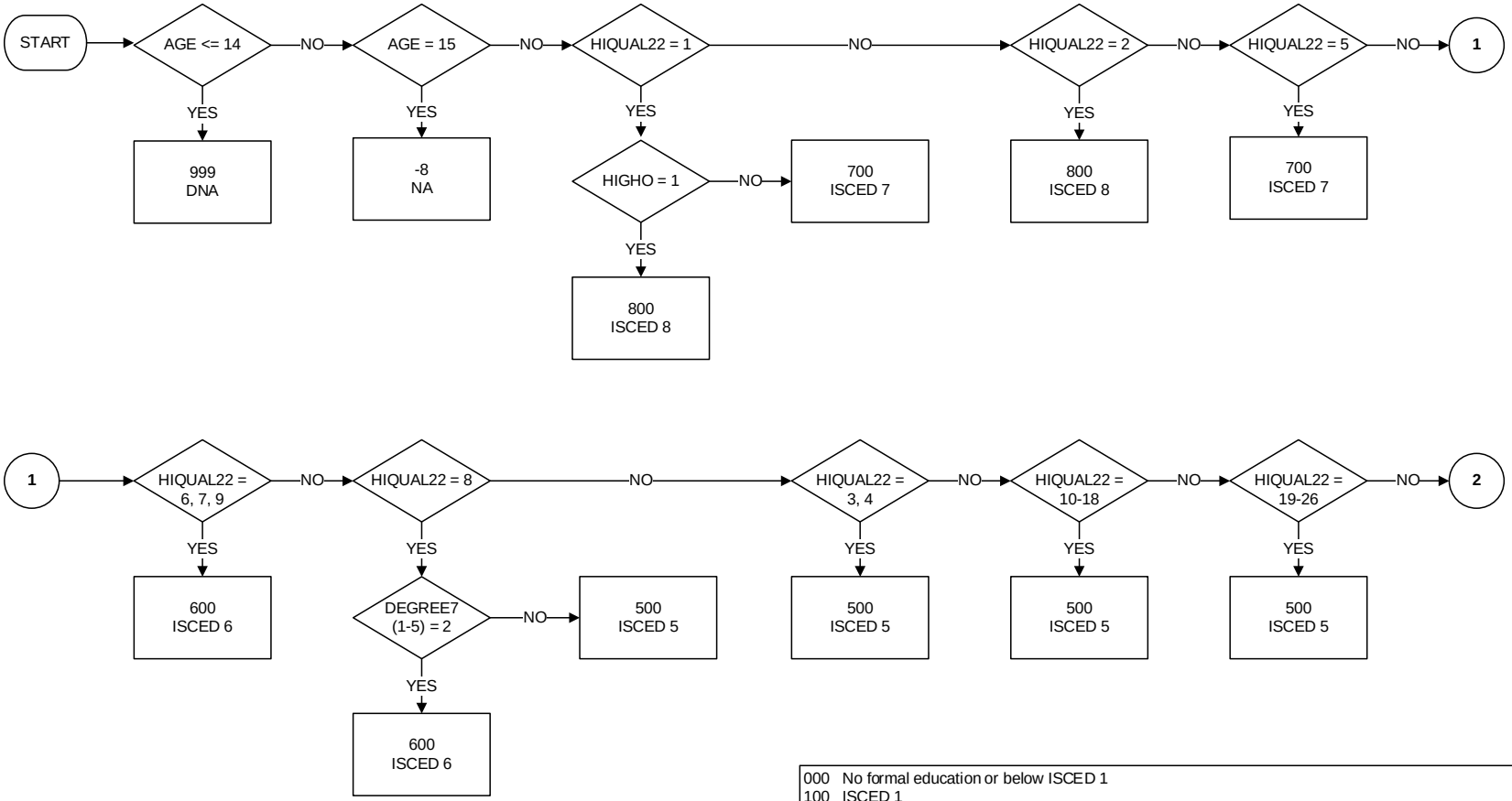
EHATLEV22 – Educational Attainment level (ISCED11)

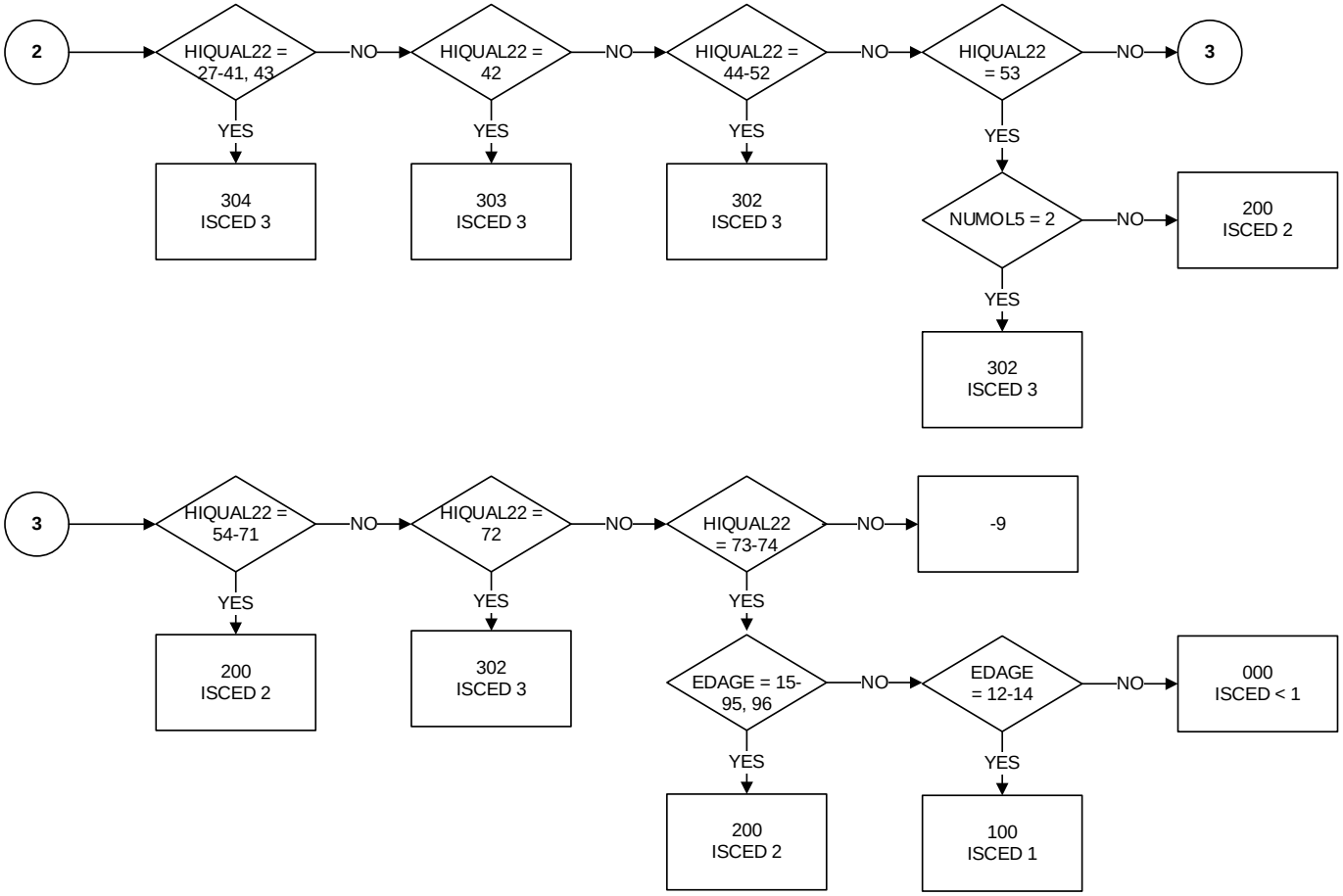
Start date: Jan 2022



000	No formal education or below ISCED 1
100	ISCED 1
200	ISCED 2 (inc ISCED 3 programmes of duration less than 2 years)
302	ISCED 3 programme duration >= 2 years, sequential (i.e. access to next ISCED 3 programme only)
303	ISCED 3 programme duration >= 2 years, terminal or access to next ISCED 4 only (N/A in UK)
304	ISCED 3 with access to ISCED 5, 6 or 7
400	ISCED 4 (N/A in UK)
500	ISCED 5
600	ISCED 6
700	ISCED 7
800	ISCED 8
999	Not applicable (age < 15)

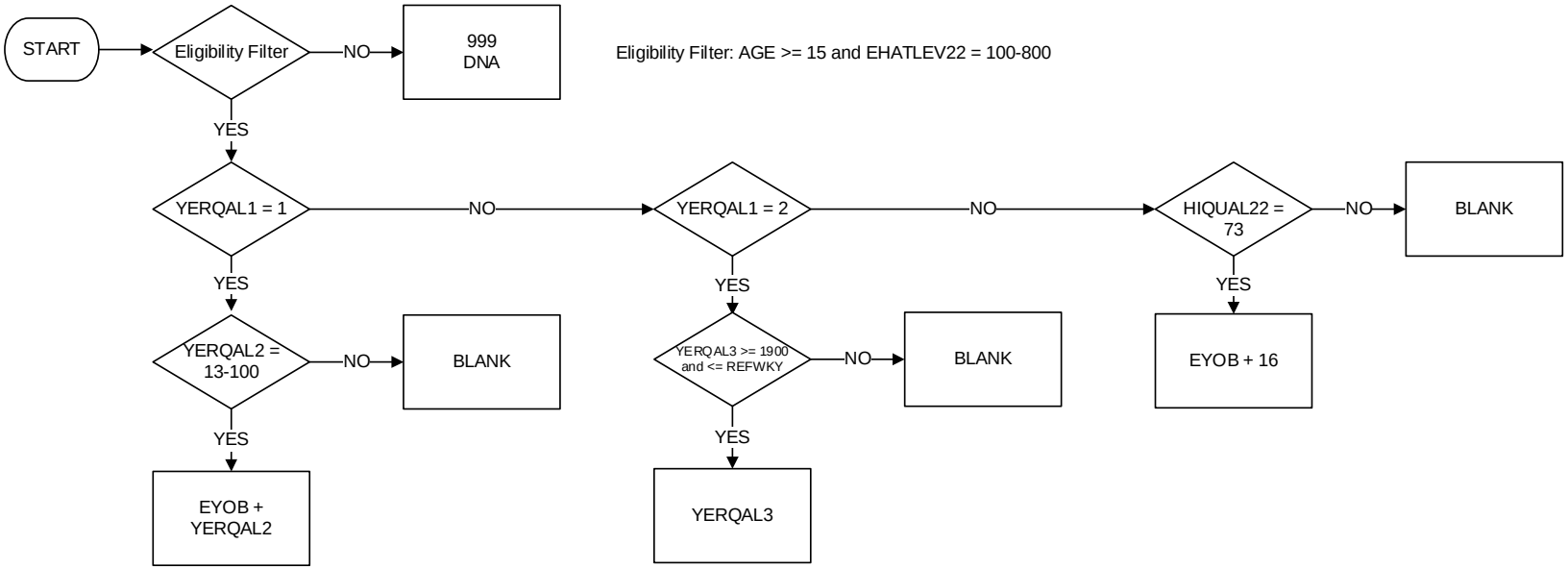
EHATLEV22 – Educational Attainment level (ISCED11)

Start date: Jan 2022



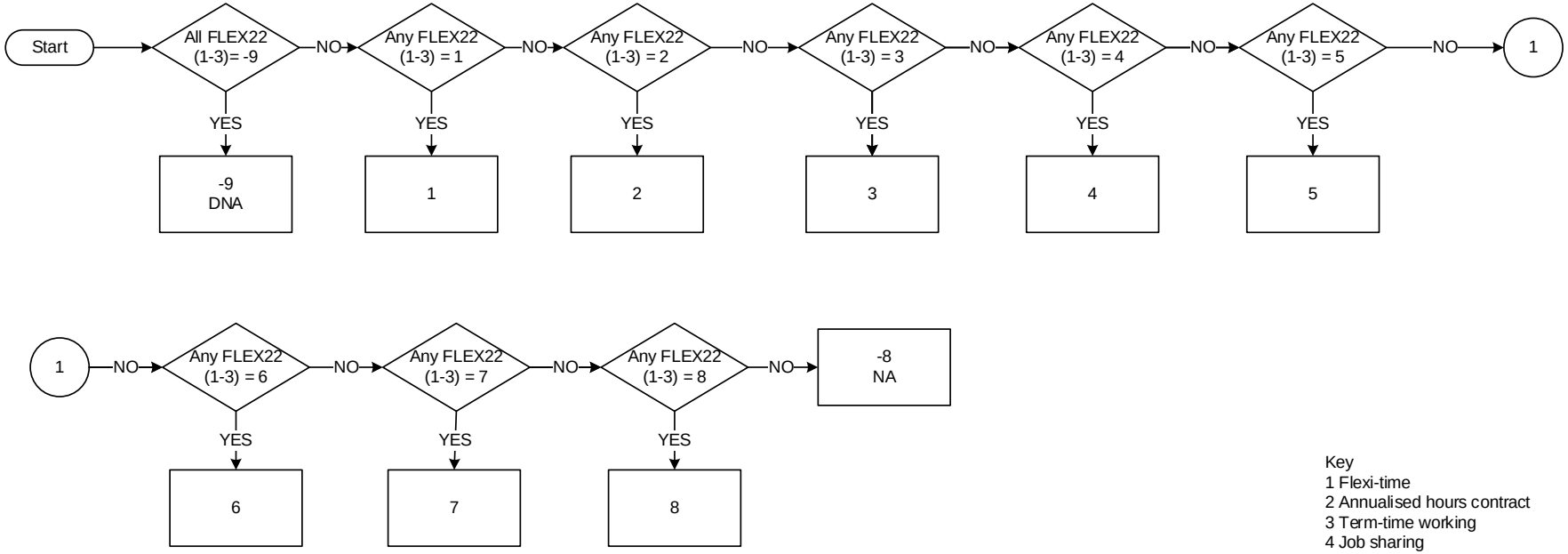
EHATYR22 Year when highest level of education or training successfully completed

Start date: Jan 2022



FLED22: Type of agreed working arrangements

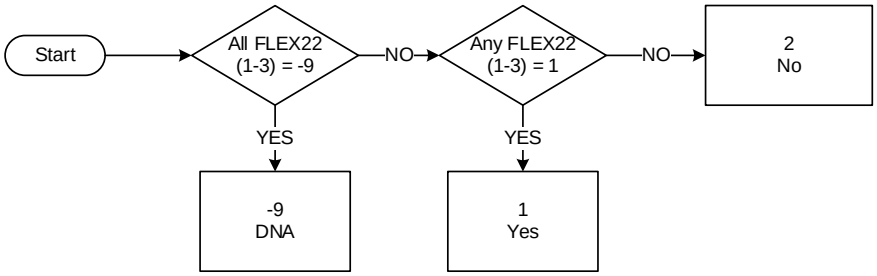
Start date: Jan 2022



Key
1 Flexi-time
2 Annualised hours contract
3 Term-time working
4 Job sharing
5 Condensed or compressed hours
6 Zero hours contract
7 On call working
8 None of these

FLEX22W1: Whether respondent works flexi-time

Start date: Jan 2022

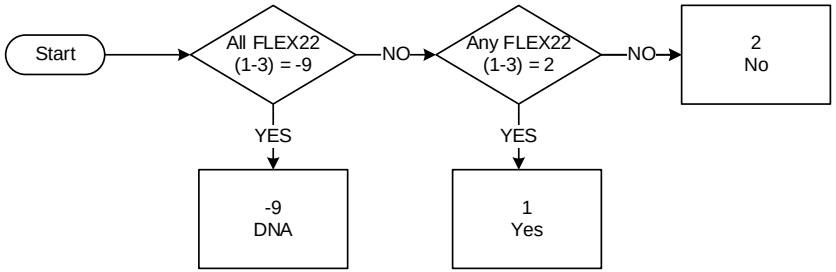


Key
1 - Respondent works flexi-time

2 – Respondent does not work flexi-time

FLEX22W2: Whether respondent works to annualised hours contract

Start date: Jan 2022

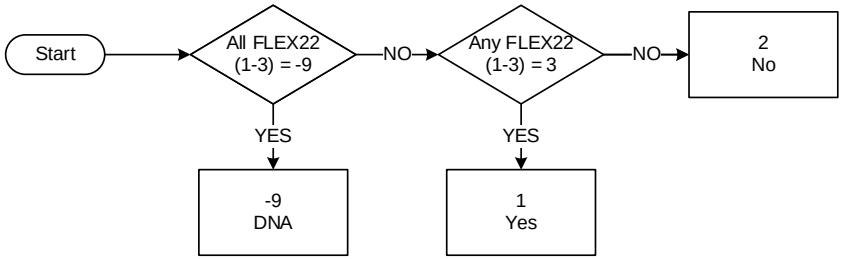


Key
1 - Respondent works to an annualised hours contract

2 – Respondent does not work to an annualised hours contract

FLEX22W3: Whether respondent works to a term time working arrangement

Start date: Jan 2022

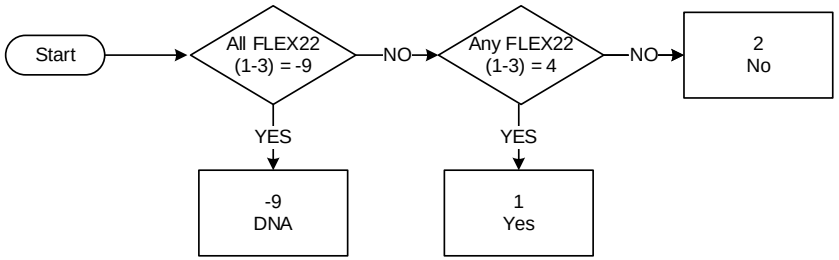


Key
1 - Respondent works to a term time working arrangement

2 – Respondent does not work a term time working arrangement

FLEX22W4: Whether respondent's work involves job sharing

Start date: Jan 2022

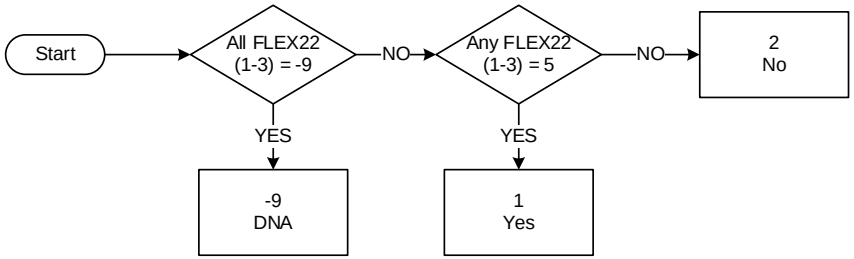


Key
1 - Respondent's work involves job sharing

2 – Respondent's work does not involve job sharing

FLEX22W5: Whether respondent works condensed/compressed hours

Start date: Jan 2022

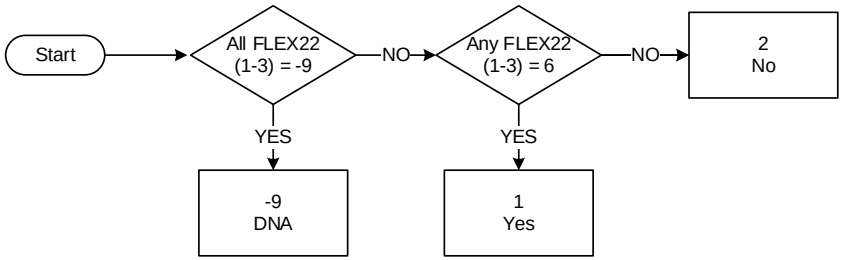


Key
1 - Respondent works condensed or compressed hours

2 – Respondent does not work condensed or compressed hours

FLEX22W6: Whether respondent works zero hours contract

Start date: Jan 2022

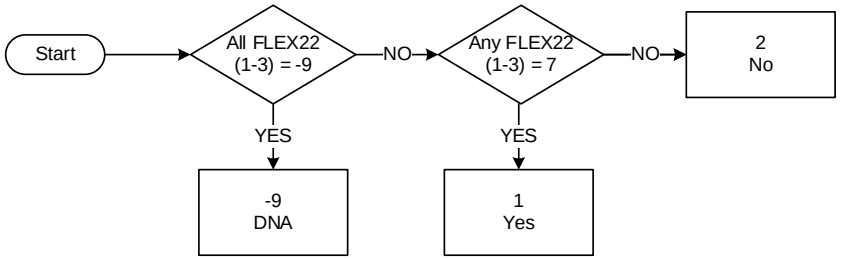


Key
1 – Respondent works a zero hours contract

2 – Respondent does not work a zero hours contract

FLEX22W7: Whether respondent works on call

Start date: Jan 2022

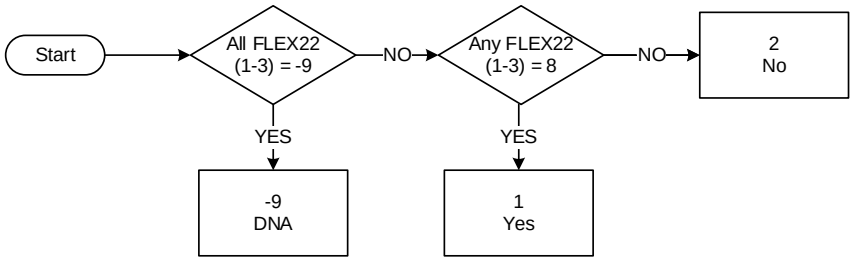


Key
1 - Respondent works on call

2 – Respondent does not work on call

FLEX22W8: Whether respondent works none of the working patterns described

Start date: Jan 2022

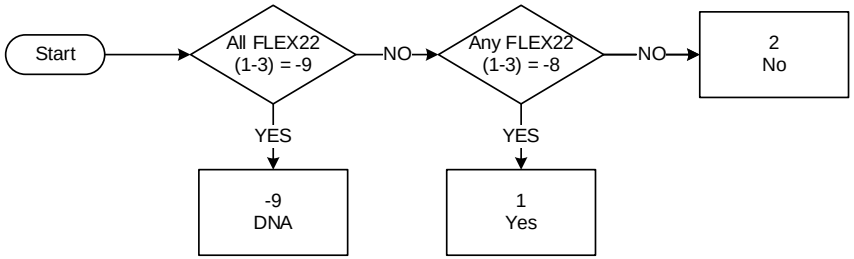


Key
1 - Respondent works none of the working patterns described

2 – Respondent works one or more of the working patterns described or replied DK

FLEX22W9: Whether respondent does not know which agreed working arrangements are worked

Start date: Jan 2022

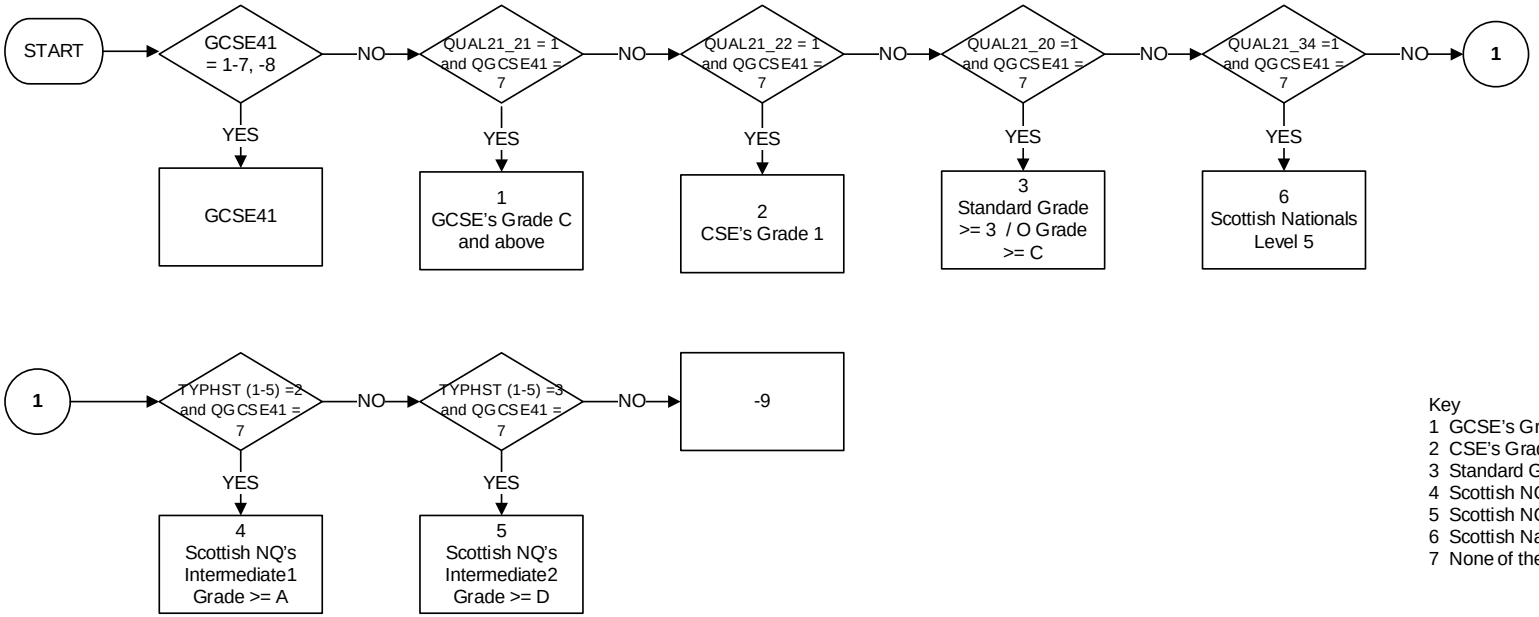


Key
1 - Respondent doesn't know which agreed working arrangements are worked

2 – Respondent replied other than 'don't know'

GCSEFUL1 – GCSE41 including inferred responses (2022 version)

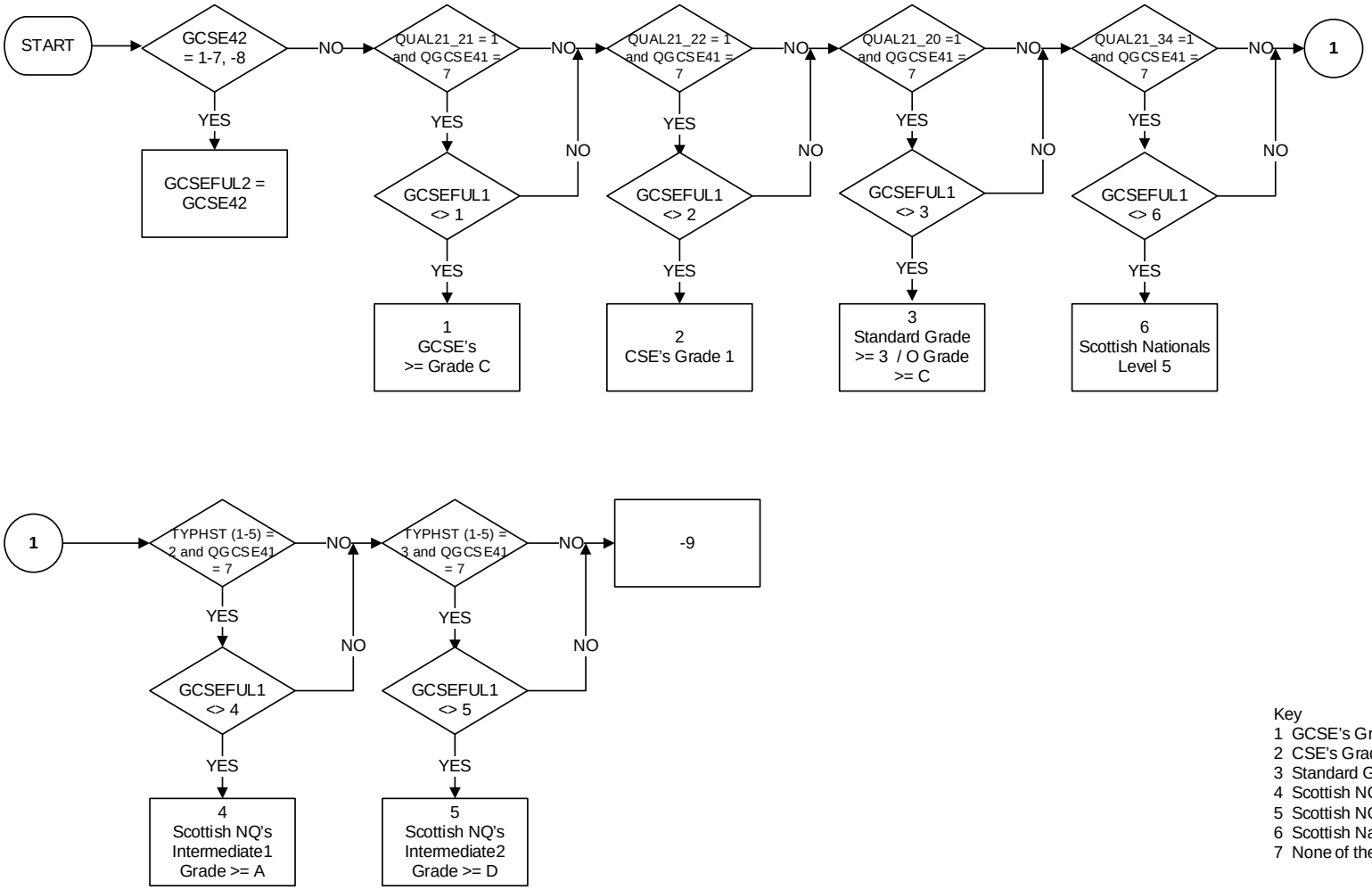
Start date: Jan 2022



Key
1 GCSE's Grade C and above
2 CSE's Grade 1
3 Standard Grade >= 3 / O Grade >= C
4 Scottish NQ's Intermediate1 Grade >= A
5 Scottish NQ's Intermediate2 Grade >= D
6 Scottish Nationals Level 5
7 None of these

GCSEFUL2 – GCSE42 including inferred responses (2022 version)

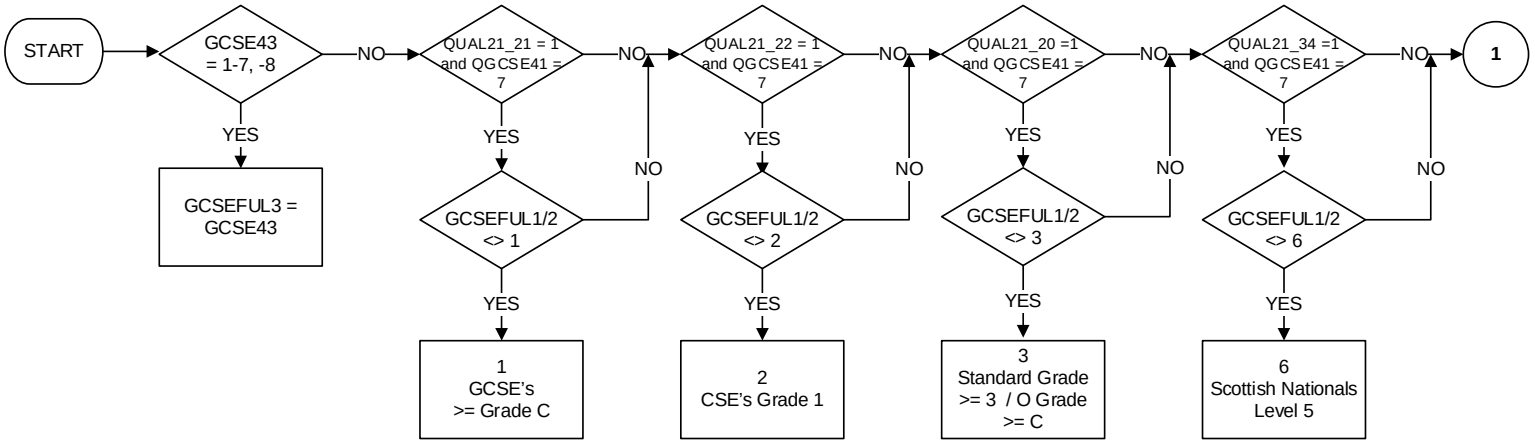
Start date: Jan 2022

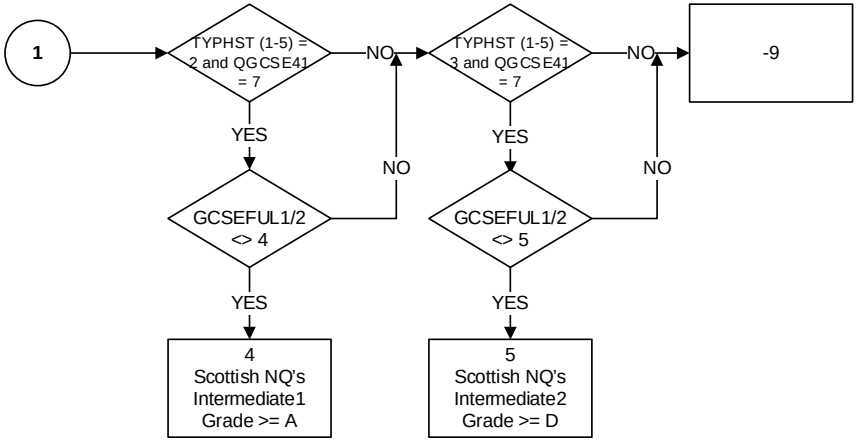


Key
1 GCSE's Grade C and above
2 CSE's Grade 1
3 Standard Grade >= 3 / O Grade >= C
4 Scottish NQ's Intermediate1 Grade >= A
5 Scottish NQ's Intermediate2 Grade >= D
6 Scottish Nationals Level 5
7 None of these

GCSEFUL3 – GCSE43 including inferred responses (2022 version)

Start date: Jan 2022

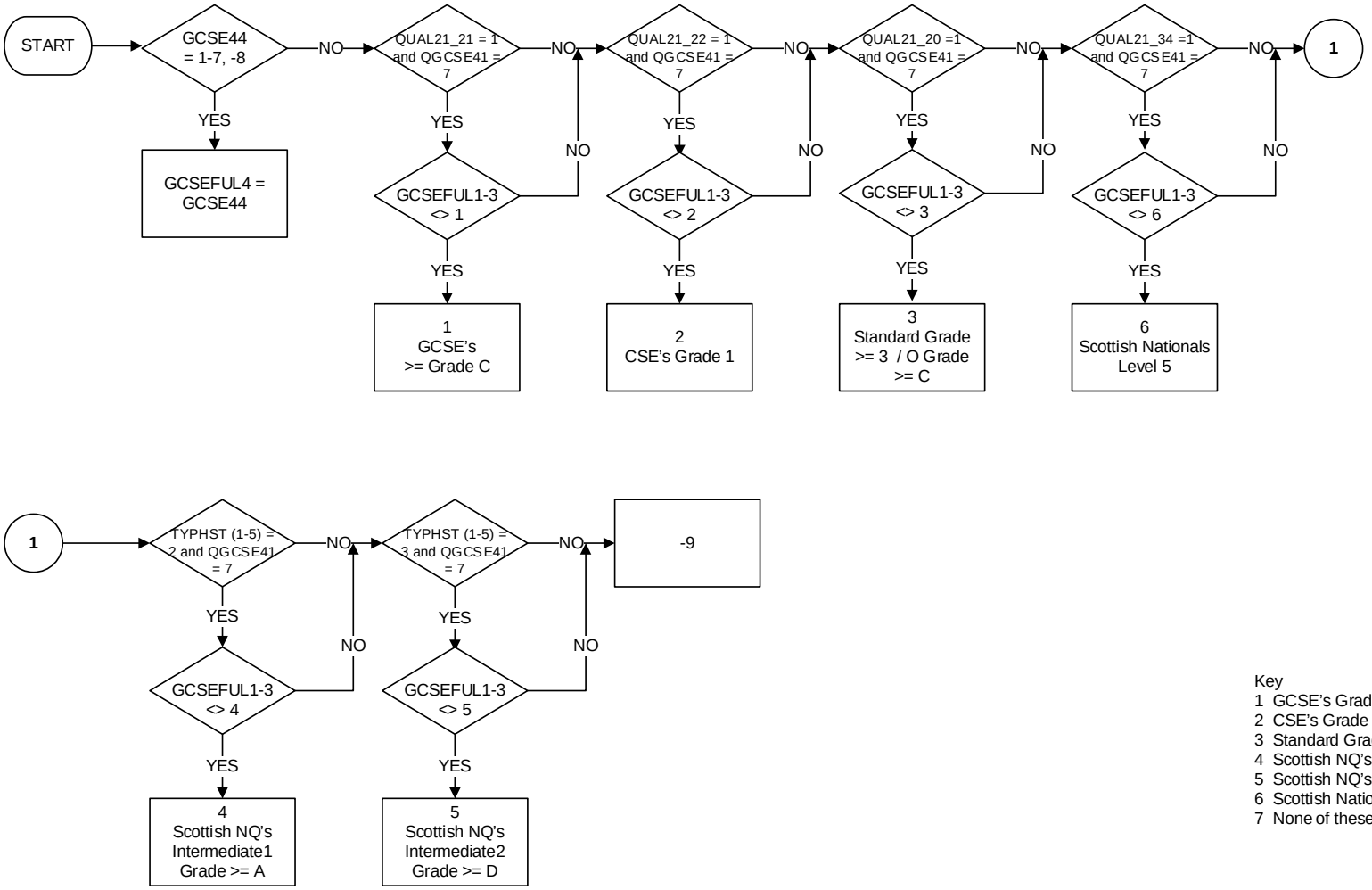




Key
1 GCSE's Grade C and above
2 CSE's Grade 1
3 Standard Grade >= 3 / O Grade >= C
4 Scottish NQ's Intermediate1 Grade >= A
5 Scottish NQ's Intermediate2 Grade >= D
6 Scottish Nationals Level 5
7 None of these

GCSEFUL4 – GCSE44 including inferred responses (2022 version)

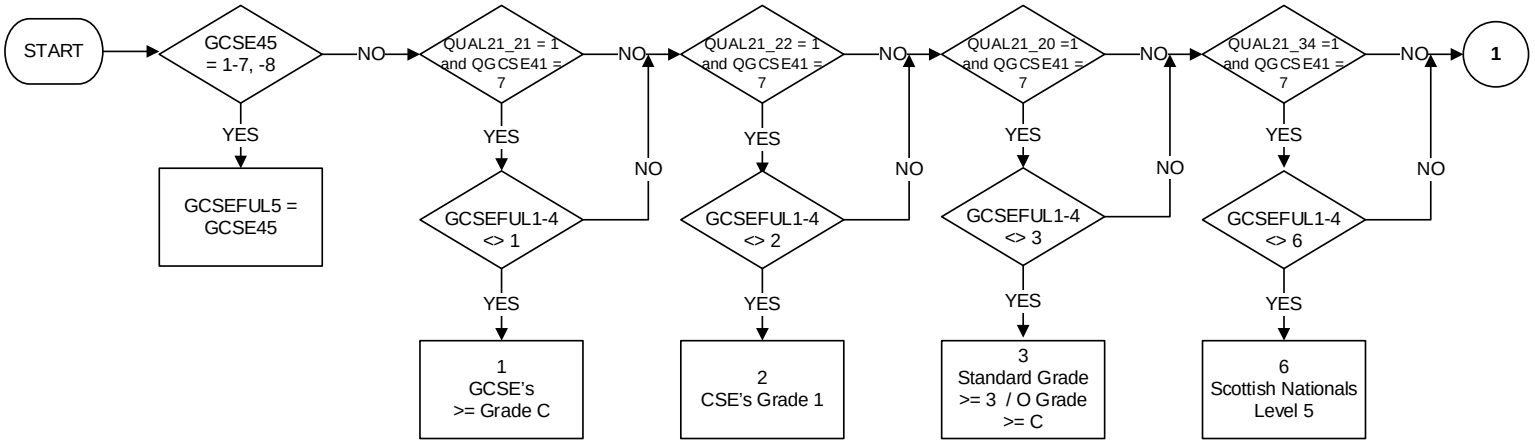
Start date: Jan 2022

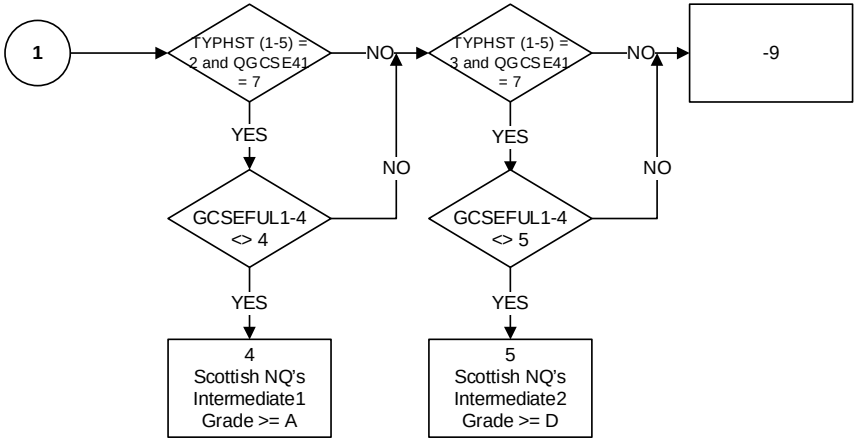


Key
1 GCSE's Grade C and above
2 CSE's Grade 1
3 Standard Grade >= 3 / O Grade >= C
4 Scottish NQ's Intermediate1 Grade >= A
5 Scottish NQ's Intermediate2 Grade >= D
6 Scottish Nationals Level 5
7 None of these

GCSEFUL5 – GCSE45 including inferred responses (2022 version)

Start date: Jan 2022

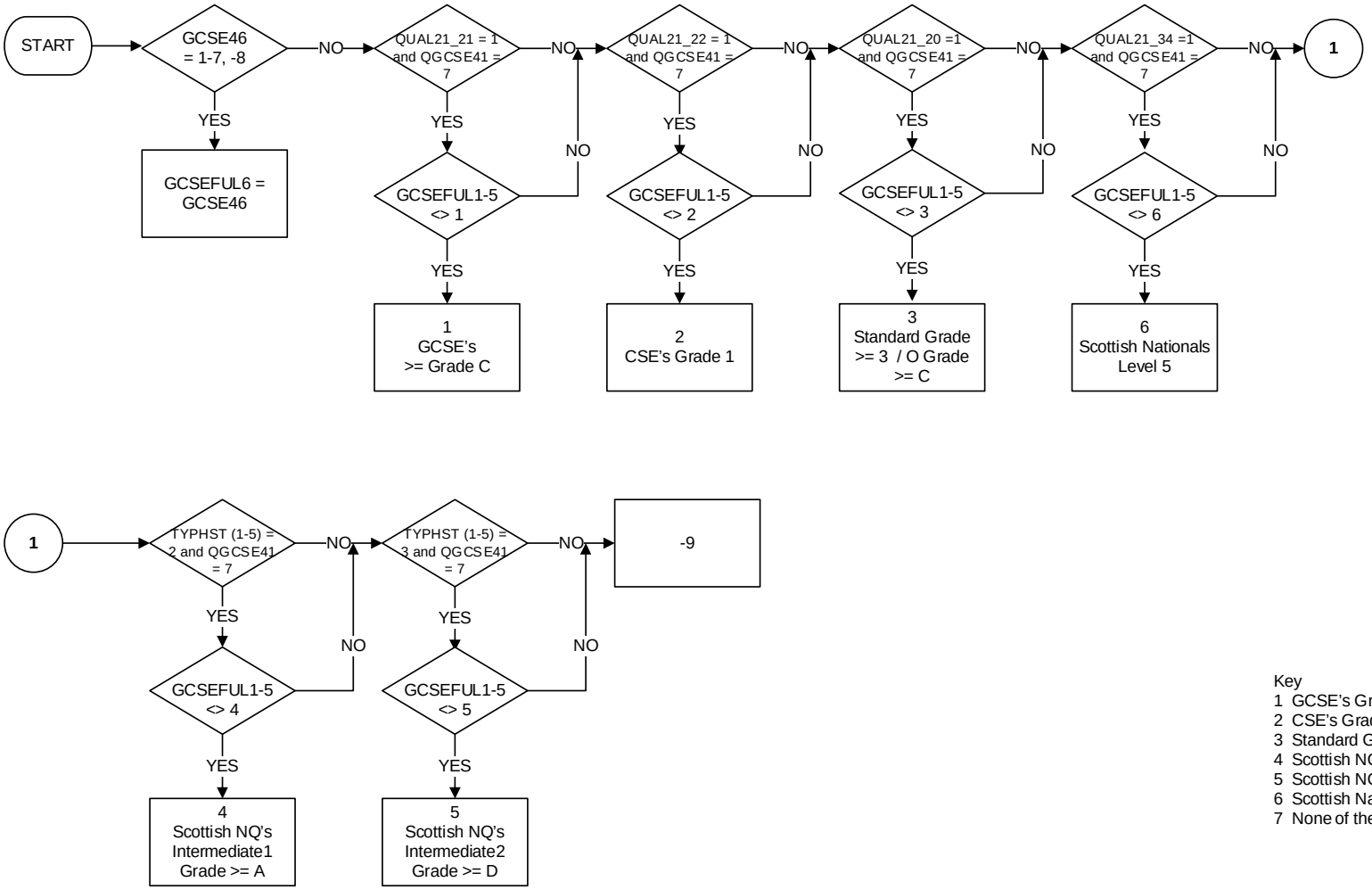




Key
1 GCSE's Grade C and above
2 CSE's Grade 1
3 Standard Grade >= 3 / O Grade >= C
4 Scottish NQ's Intermediate1 Grade >= A
5 Scottish NQ's Intermediate2 Grade >= D
6 Scottish Nationals Level 5
7 None of these

GCSEFUL6 – GCSE46 including inferred responses (2022 version)

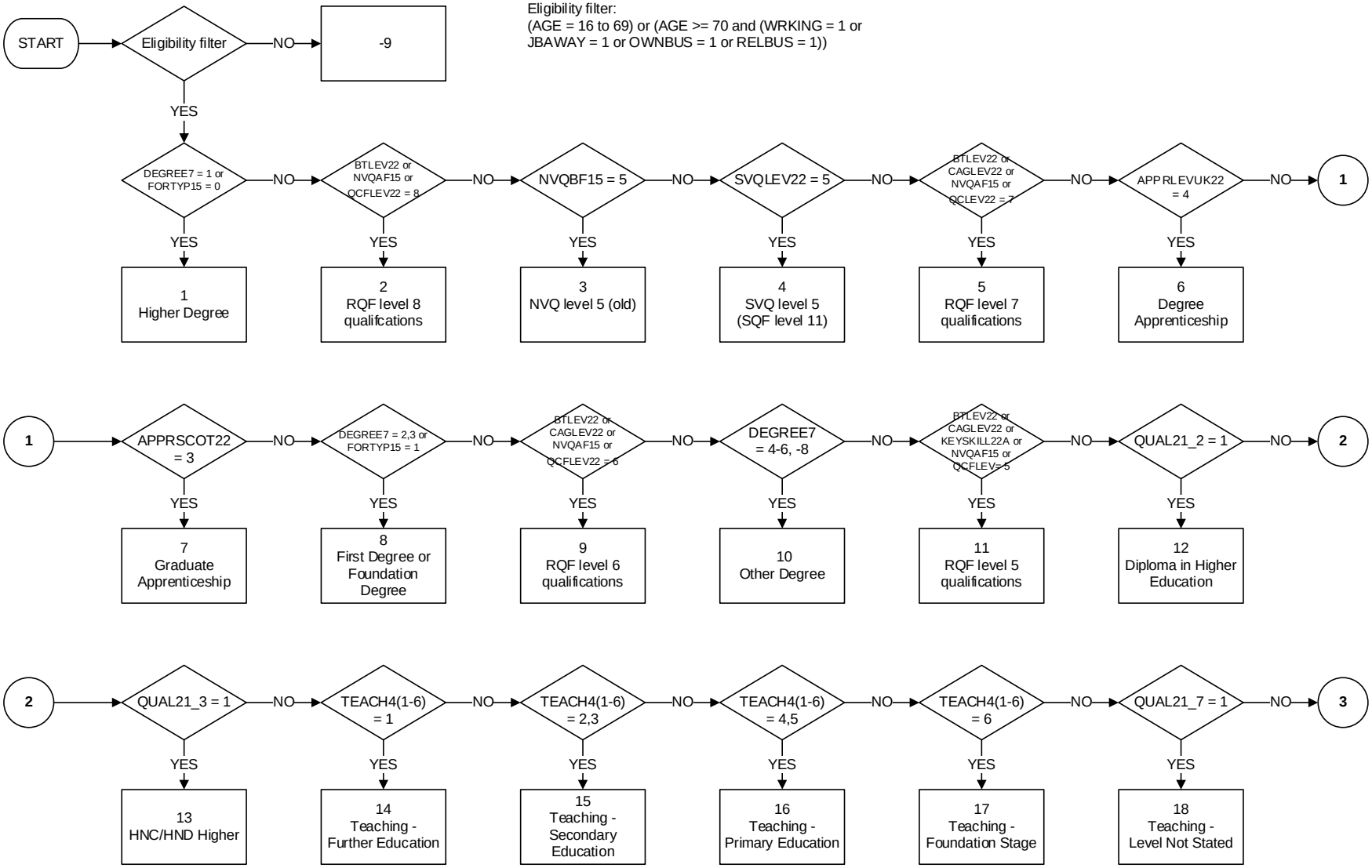
Start date: Jan 2022



Key
1 GCSE's Grade C and above
2 CSE's Grade 1
3 Standard Grade >= 3 / O Grade >= C
4 Scottish NQ's Intermediate1 Grade >= A
5 Scottish NQ's Intermediate2 Grade >= D
6 Scottish Nationals Level 5
7 None of these

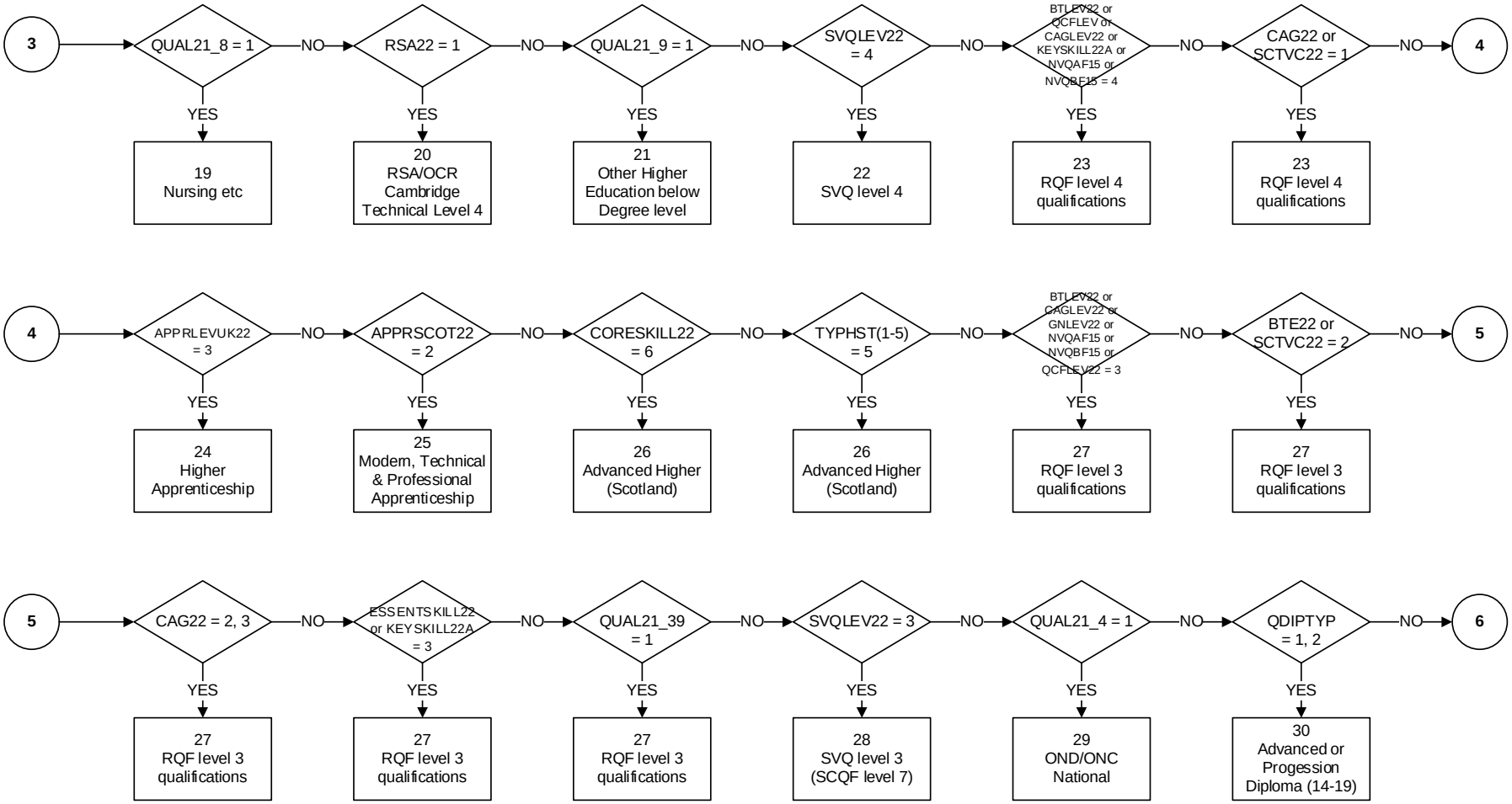
HIQUAL22 - Highest qualification/ Trade apprenticeship

Start date: Jan 2022



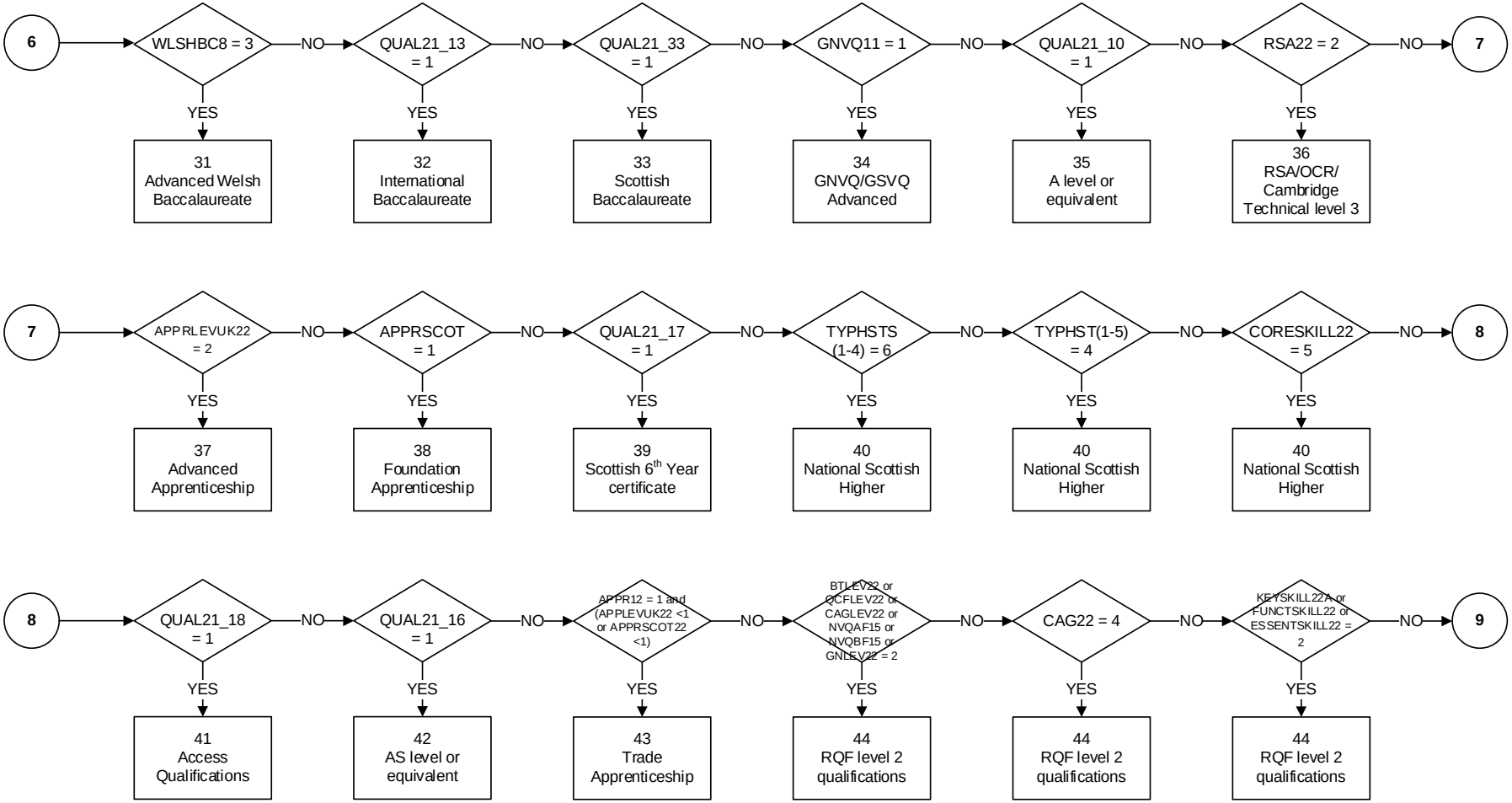
HIQUAL22 - Highest qualification/ Trade apprenticeship

Start date: Jan 2022



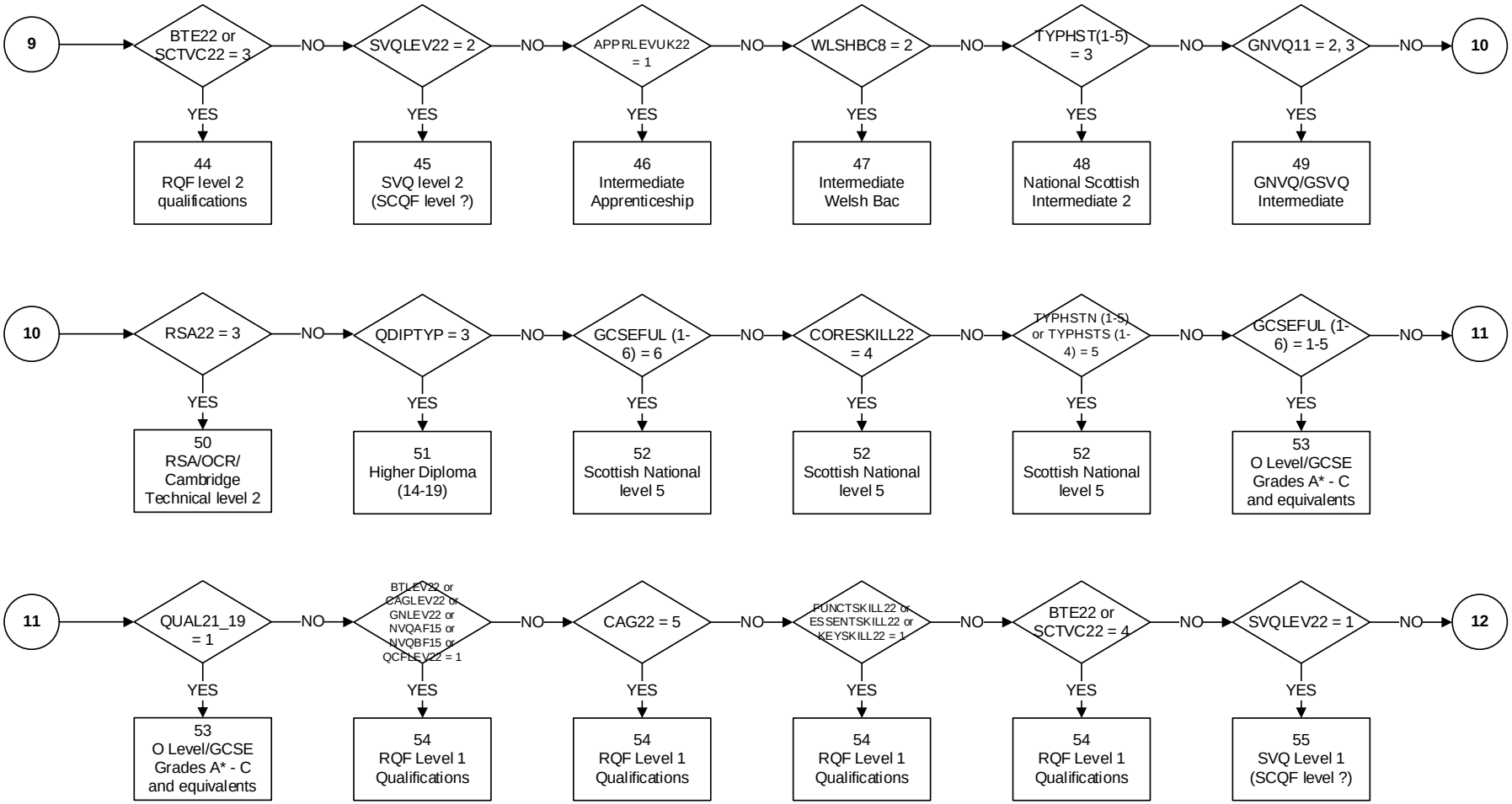
HIQUAL22 - Highest qualification/ Trade apprenticeship

Start date: Jan 2022



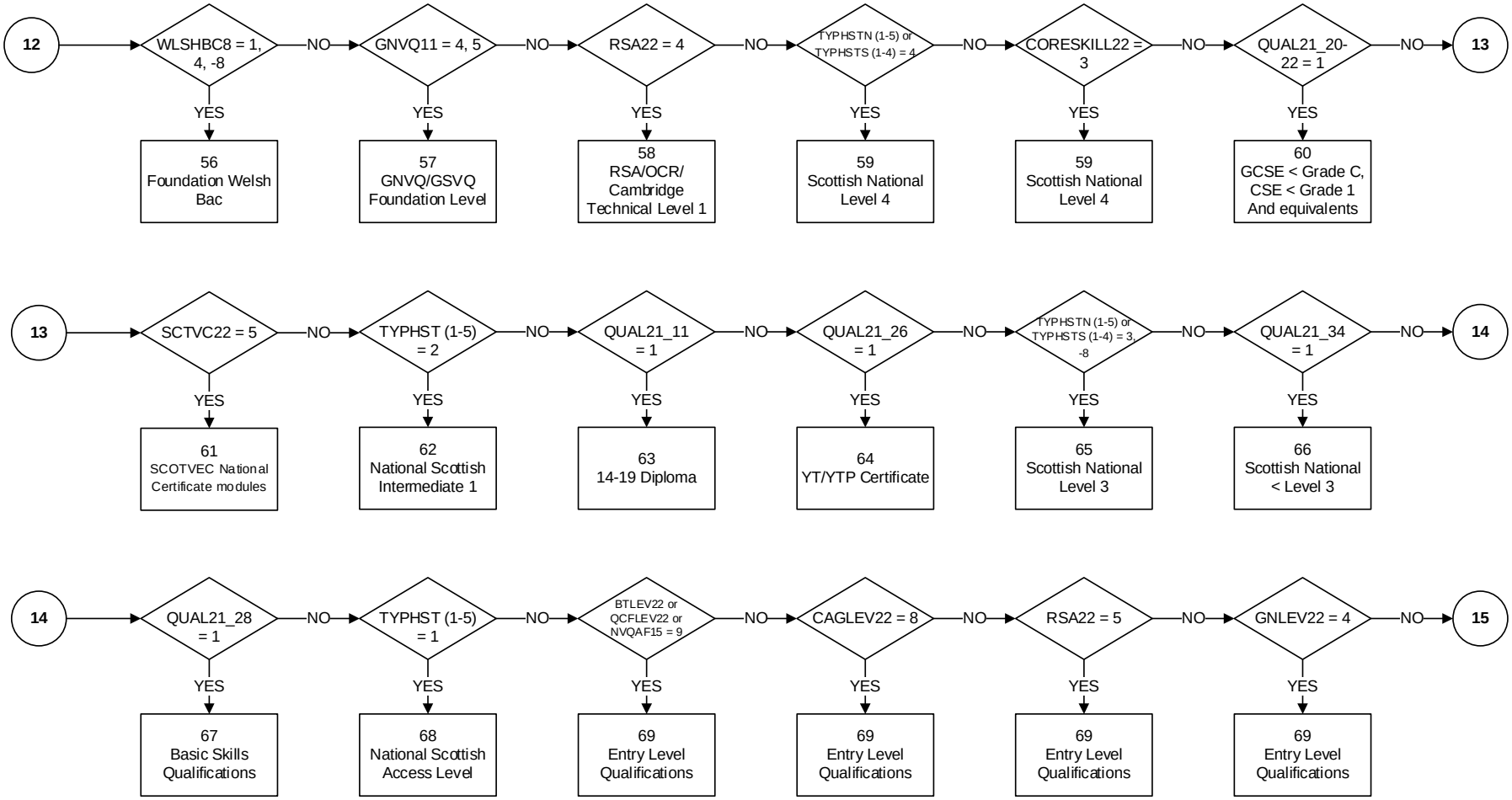
HIQUAL22 - Highest qualification/ Trade apprenticeship

Start date: Jan 2022



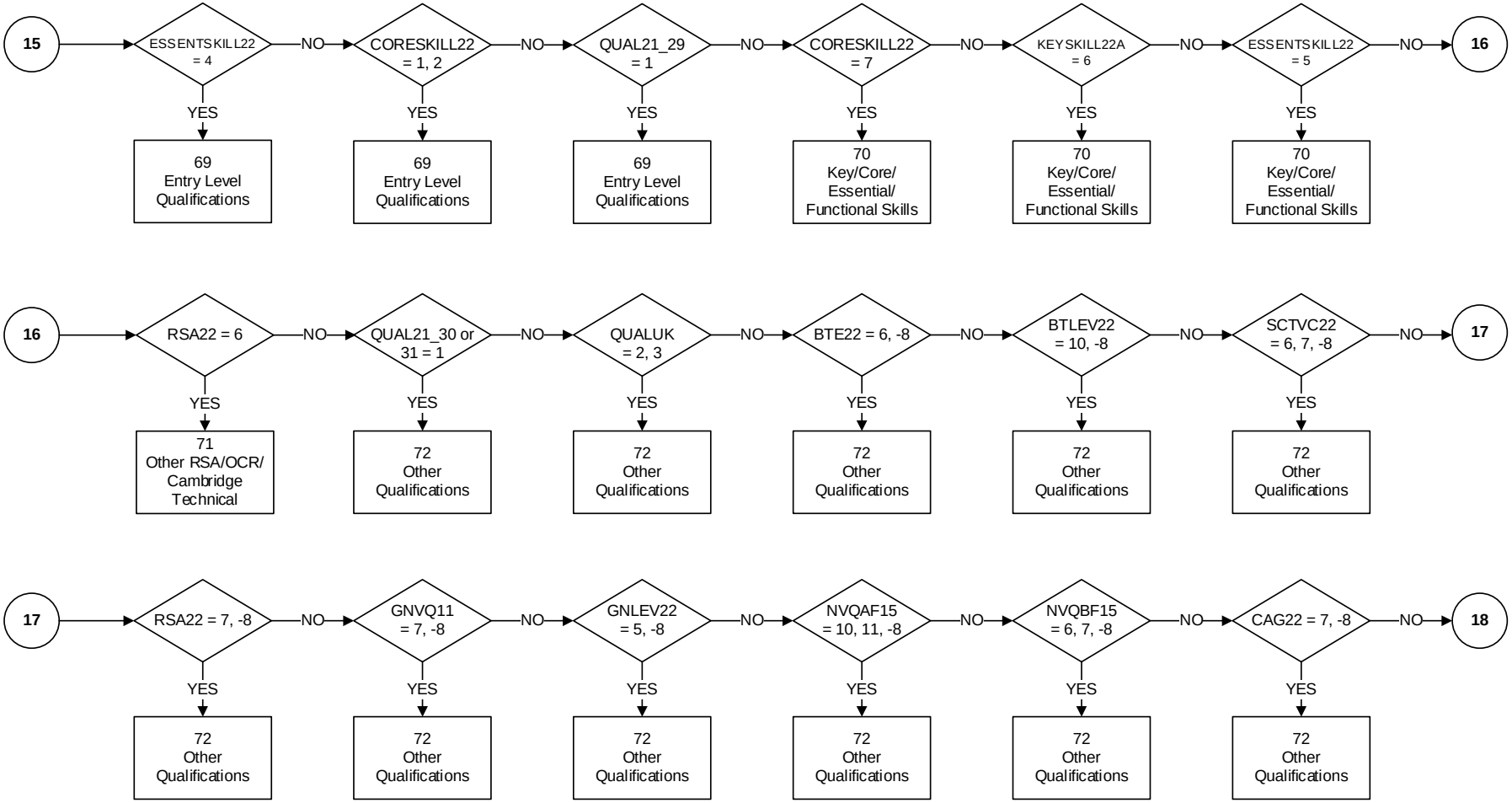
HIQUAL22 - Highest qualification/ Trade apprenticeship

Start date: Jan 2022



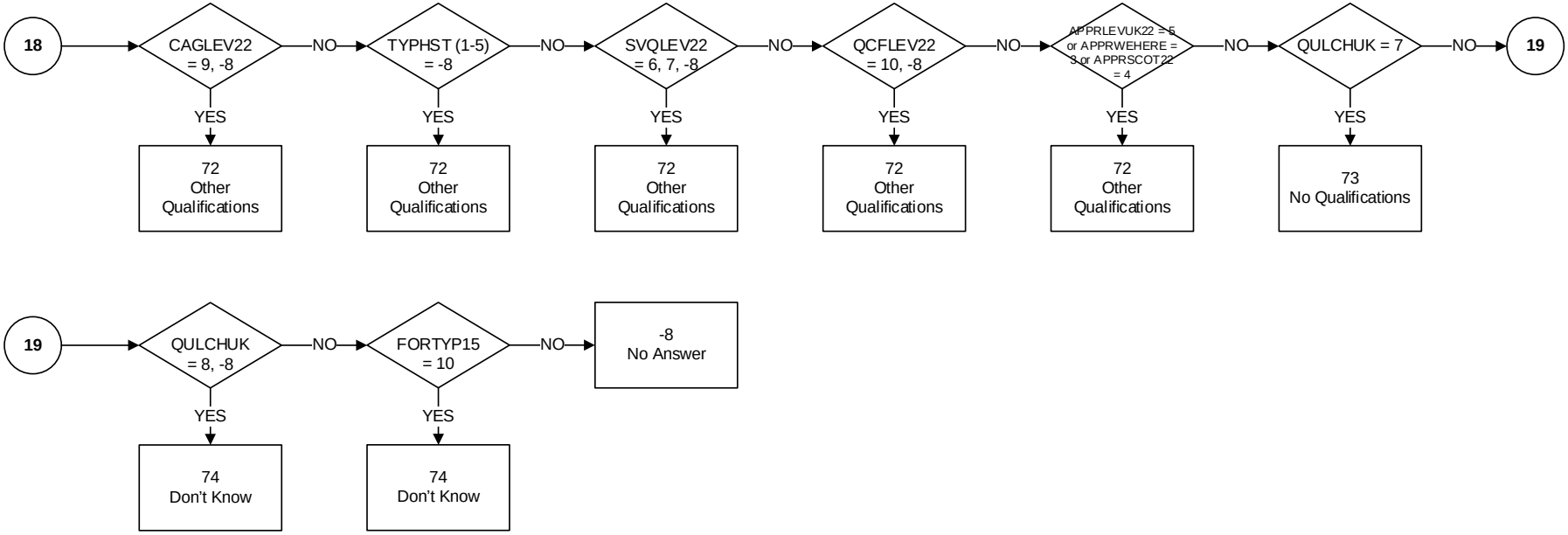
HIQUAL22 - Highest qualification/ Trade apprenticeship

Start date: Jan 2022



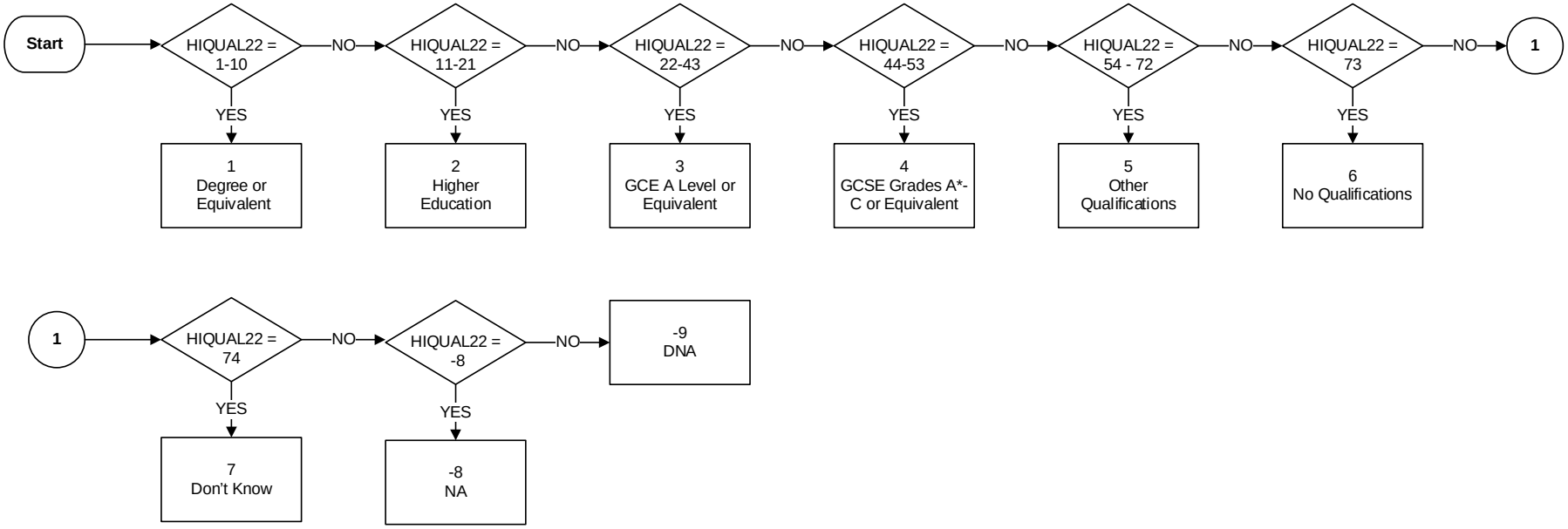
HIQUAL22 - Highest qualification/ Trade apprenticeship

Start date: Jan 2022



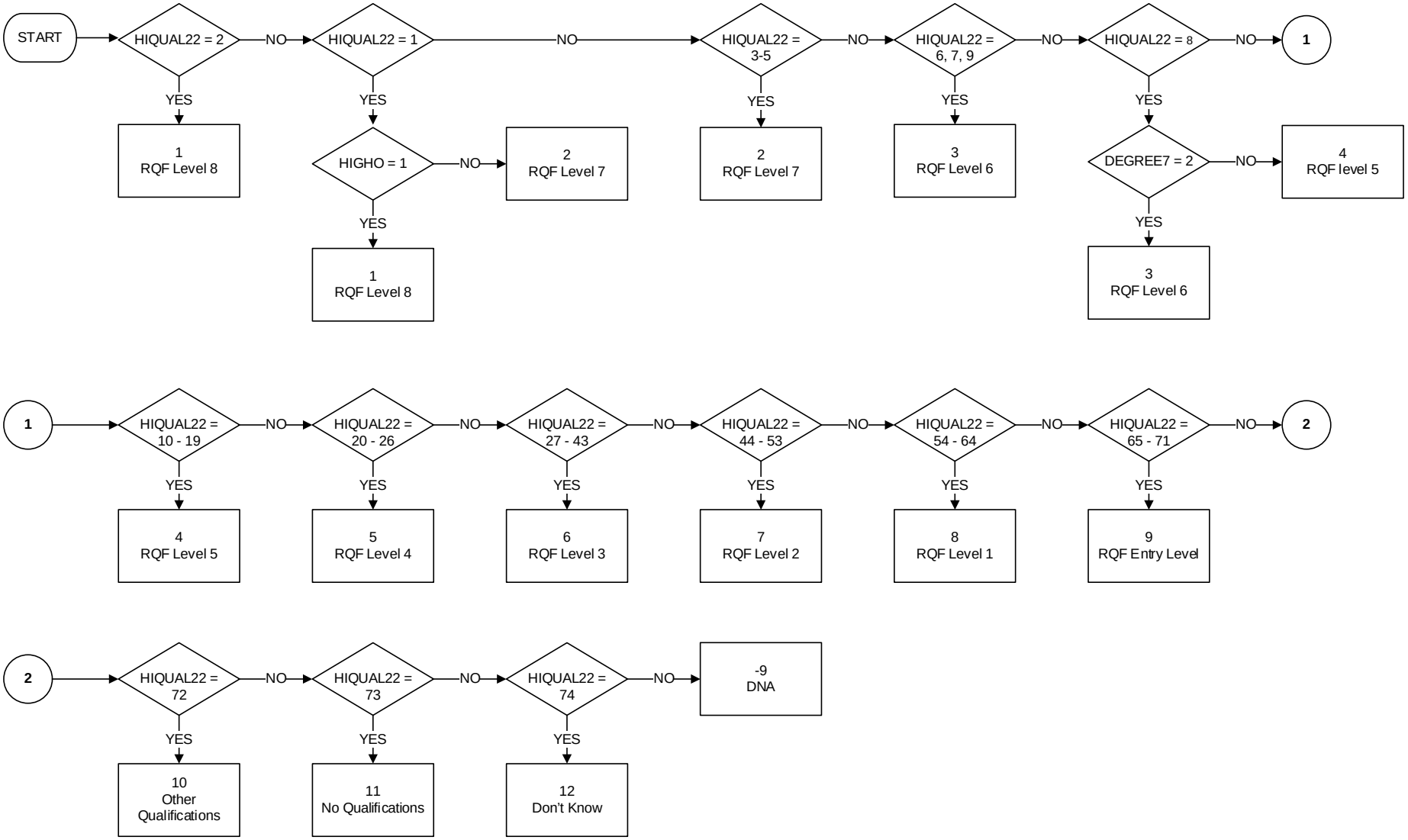
HIQUL22D - Highest qualification/ Trade apprenticeship (detailed grouping)

Start date: Jan 2022



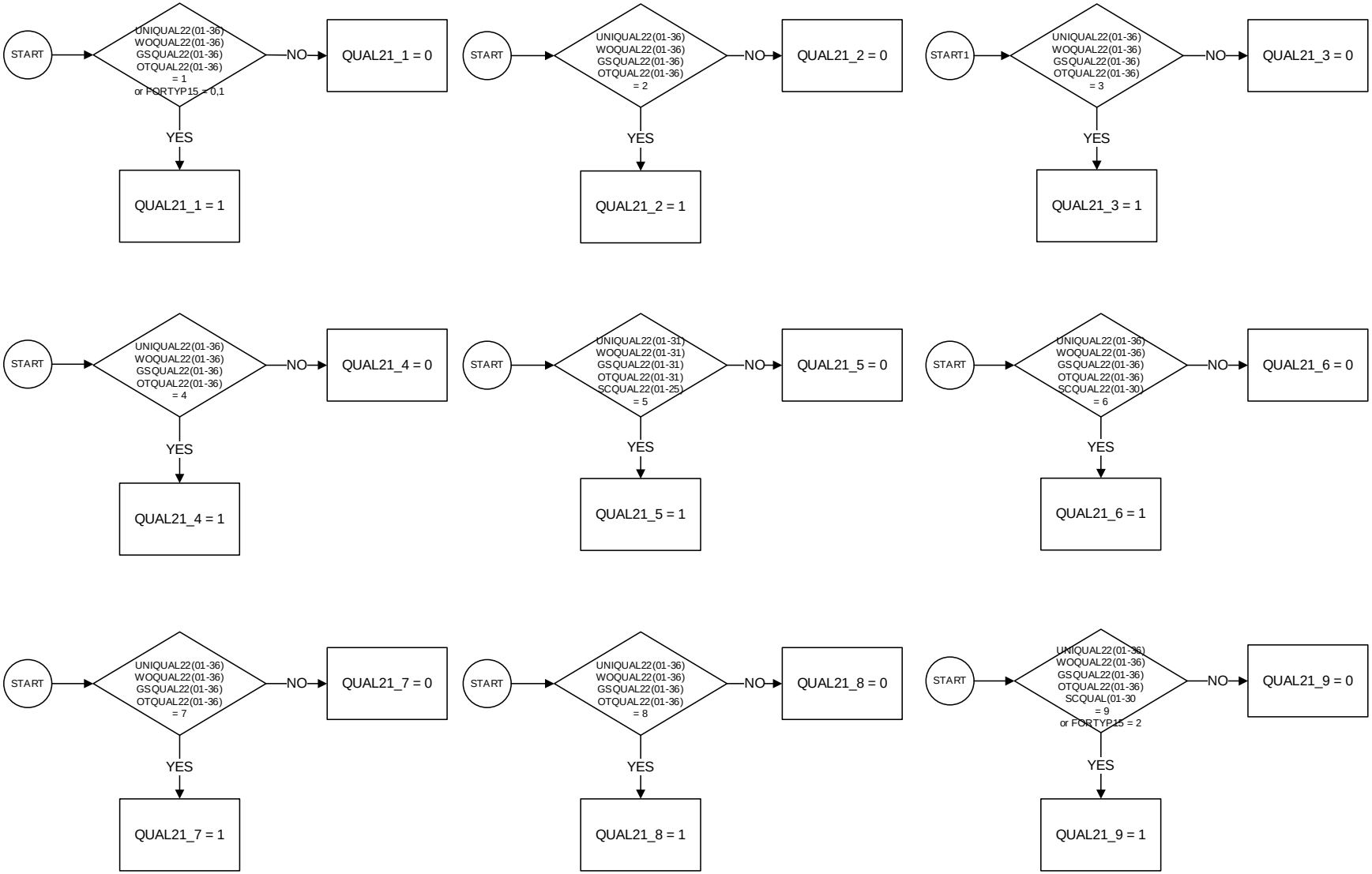
LEVQUL22 – RQF Level of highest qualification held

Start date: Jan 2022



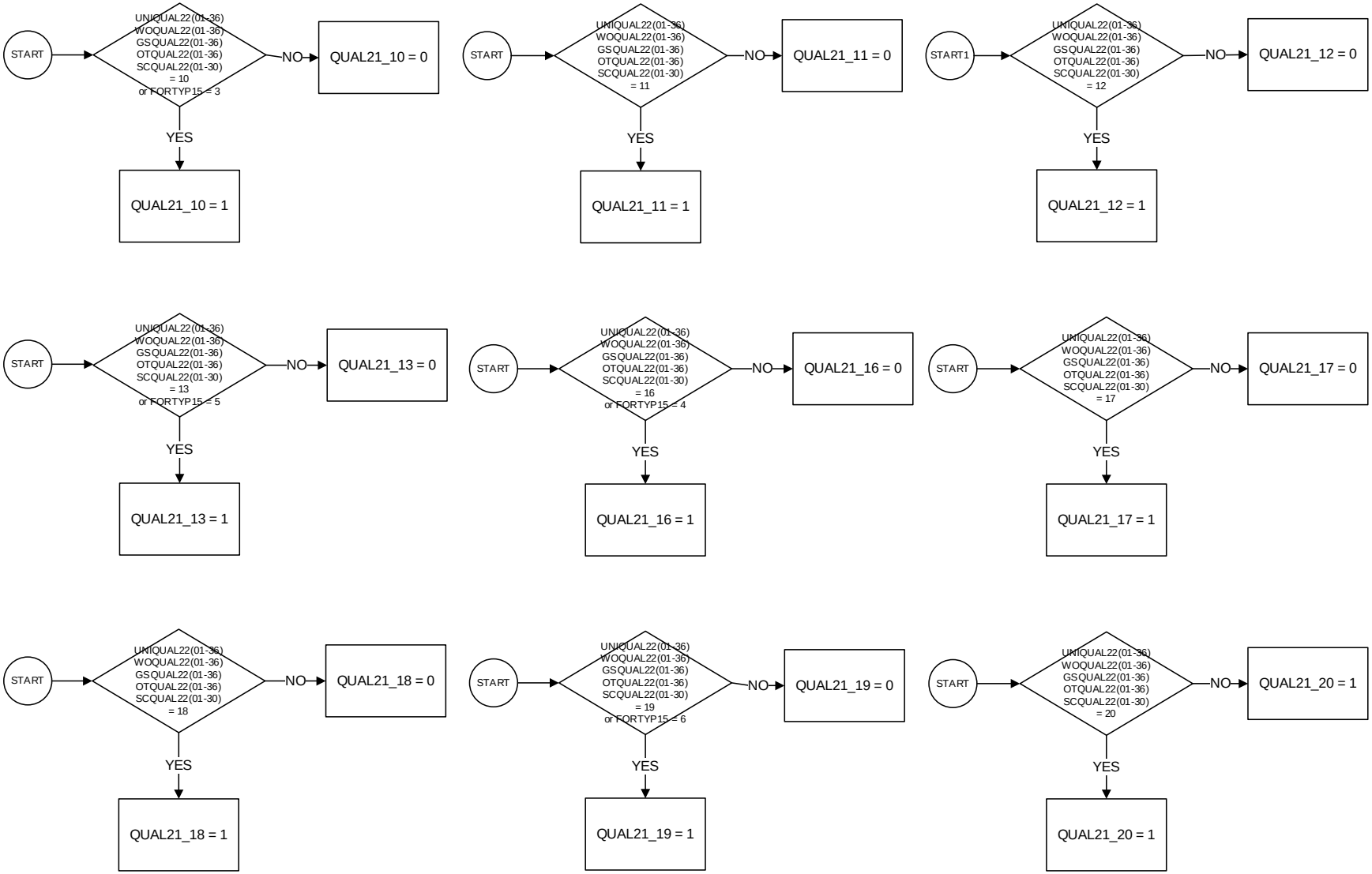
QUAL21_1 to QUAL21_39 – Individual Qualifications Gained

Start date: Jan 2022



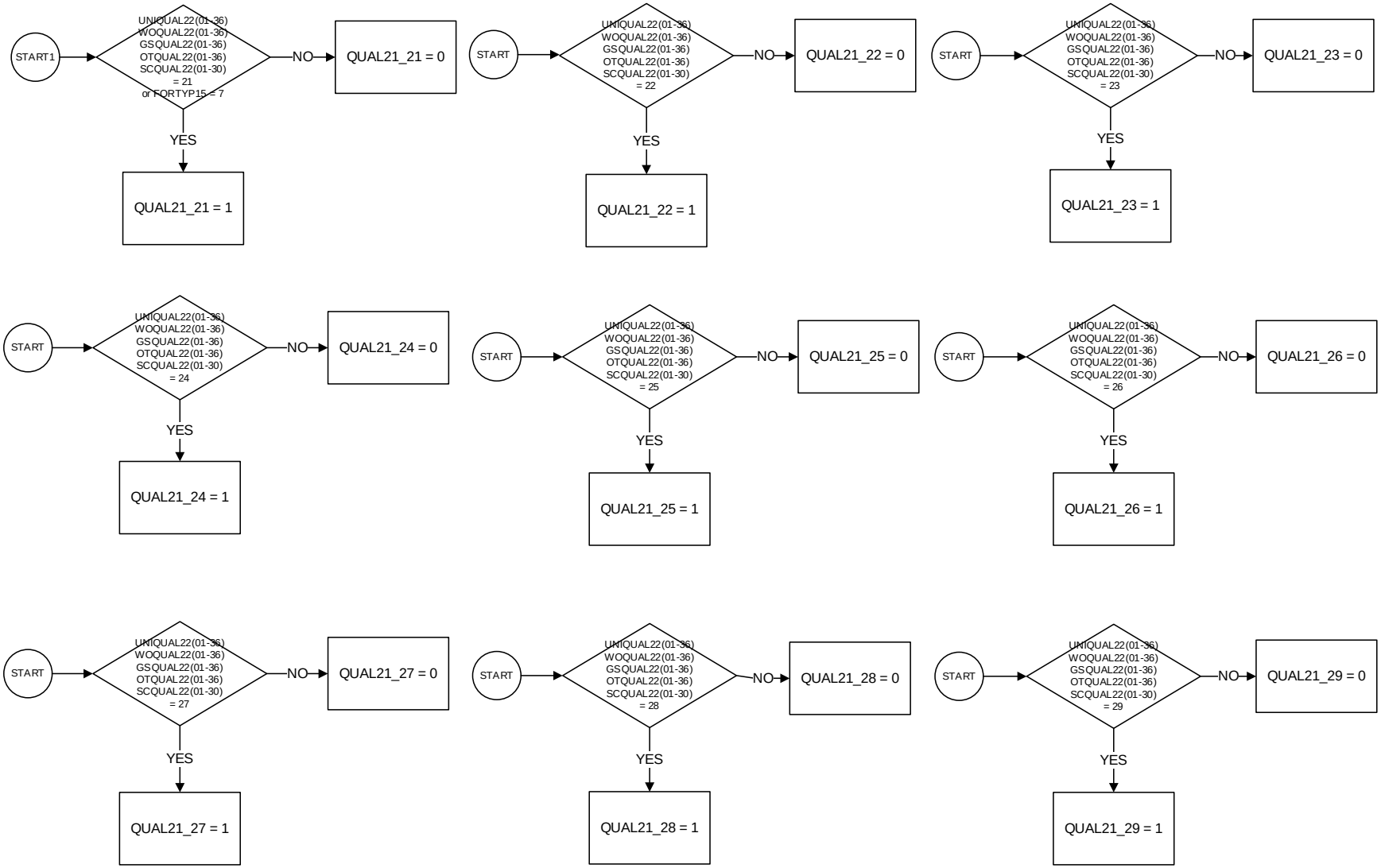
QUAL21_1 to QUAL21_39 – Individual Qualifications Gained

Start date: Jan 2022



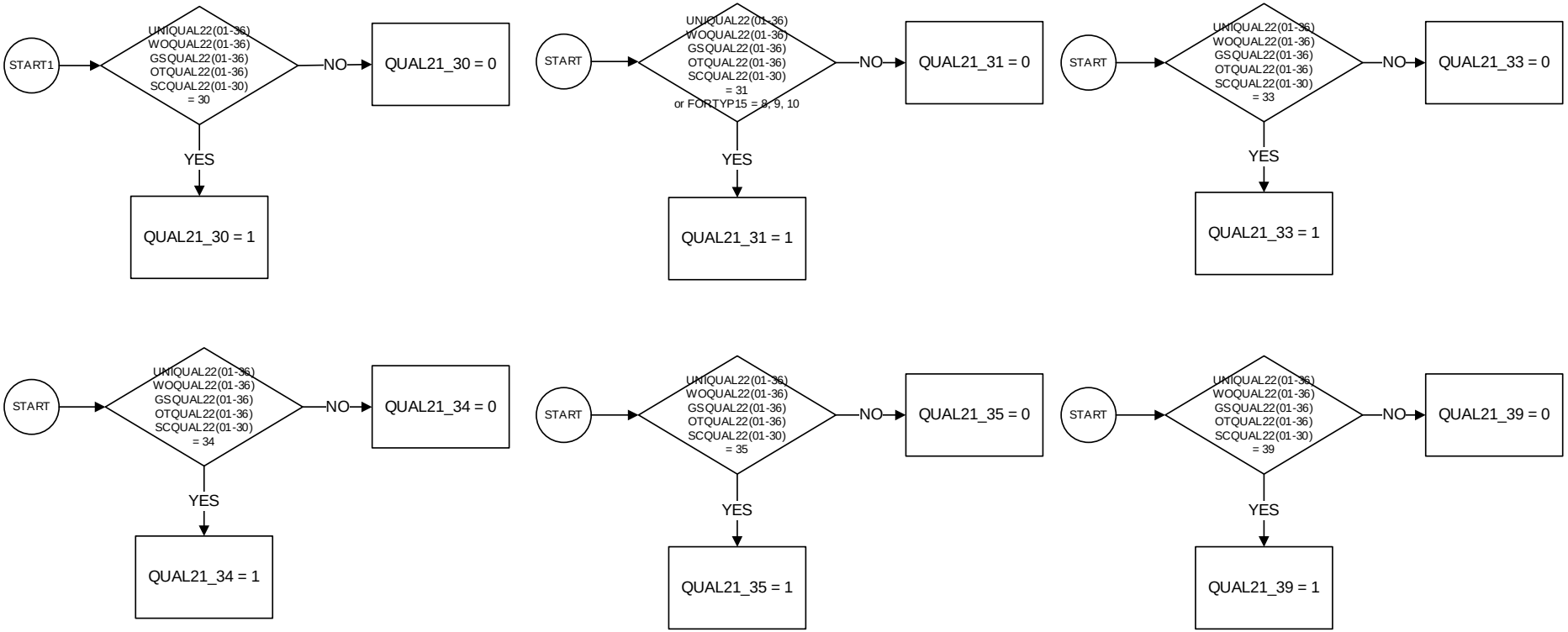
QUAL21_1 to QUAL21_39 – Individual Qualifications Gained

Start date: Jan 2022



QUAL21_1 to QUAL21_39 – Individual Qualifications Gained

Start date: Jan 2022



QUAL21_1 to QUAL21_39 – Individual Qualifications Gained

Start date: Jan 2022

QUAL21_1 to QUAL21_39 codes every qualification gained from school, university, work, government schemes and other and foreign qualifications, giving a list of all qualifications gained, regardless of where from. For example, if a respondent has: QUAL21_1 = 1 and QUAL21_7 = 1 and QUAL21_29 = 1 this indicates that they have: a degree level qualification, a teaching qualification and an Entry Level quaification.

Key
QUAL21_1 – Degree level qualification including foundation degree, graduate membership of a professional institute, PGCE, or higher qualifications
QUAL21_2 – Diploma in Higher Education
QUAL21_3 – HNC/HND
QUAL21_4 – ONC/OND
QUAL21_5 – BECTEC/BEC/TEC/Edexcel/LQL
QUAL21_6 – SCOTVEC/SCOTEC/SCOTBEC
QUAL21_7 – Teaching qualification (exc PGCE)
QUAL21_8 – Nursing or other medical qualification not yet mentioned
QUAL21_9 – Other Higher Education qualification below degree level
QUAL21_10 – A Level/Vocational A Level/GCE in applied subjects or equivalents
QUAL21_11 – New Diploma
QUAL21_12 – Welsh Baccalaureate
QUAL21_13 – New Baccalaureate
QUAL21_14 – N/A (NVQ/SVQ to Dec 2021)
QUAL21_15 – N/A (GNVQ/GSVQ to Dec 2021)
QUAL21_16 – AS Level/Vocational AS Level or equivalent
QUAL21_17 – Certificate of 6th Year Studies (CSYS) or equivalent
QUAL21_18 – Access to Higher Education
QUAL21_19 – O Level or equivalent
QUAL21_20 – Standard/Ordinary (O) grade/Lower (Scotland)
QUAL21_21 – GCSE/Vovational GCSE
QUAL21_22 – CSE
QUAL21_23 – Advanced Higher/Higher/Intermediate/Access qualifications (Scotland)
QUAL21_24 – RSA/OCR
QUAL21_25 – City & Guilds
QUAL21_26 – YouthTraining (YT) Certificate
QUAL21_27 – Key Skills/Core Skills (Scotland)
QUAL21_28 – Basic Skills (Skills for Life/Literacy/Numeracy/Language)
QUAL21_29 – Entry Level qualifications
QUAL21_30 – Award/Certificate/Diploma at Entry Level or Levels 1-8
QUAL21_31 – Any other professional/work related qualification
QUAL21_32 – N/A
QUAL21_33 – Scottish Baccalaureate
QUAL21_34 – Scottish Nationals
QUAL21_35 – Skills for Work (Scotland)
QUAL21_36 – N/A
QUAL21_37 – N/A
QUAL21_38 – N/A
QUAL21_39 – Core Maths

A Note on the lower counts for the new or revised education variables in JM22

IOUTCOME = 6 identifies cases for which there is a) no response in the current quarter, and b) a response in the previous quarter. In such circumstances the previous quarter's data is 'brought forward' – such cases are also described as 'data brought forward' (DBF).

However, when the underlying questionnaire variables change, as happened with a number of the education questions from OD21 into JM22, the practice of bringing forward the values from the previous quarter is not possible. As such, the new/revised education derived variables (eg HIQUAL22 and LEVQUL22) through JM22 will not include values for any IOUTCOME = 6 (DBF) cases, which typically constitute up to 25% of the total. The counts for the responding IOUTCOME categories – 1 Personal Responders and 2 Proxy Responses – are broadly consistent with previous quarters.